

A variety of third-party games and applications are available for purchase or even free download. If you are a power user who would like to use specific games or applications on your mobile, you will need to check whether they are supported on your new phone.

Data Input Mode

 If you are buying a high-end smartphone, you also need to consider the mode of data input. Some phones use a touch-screen and stylus to enter data, while some may offer a full-fledged keyboard. Some phones come with both options. If you are going to enter a lot of data, make sure you are comfortable with the options available.

A screen protector is a transparent film that sticks on to the top of the screen.

Change That Look

 Most Nokia phones, and even some other brands, allow you to customise the look of your phone by changing the external body casing, keypads, etc. You can choose from lots of stickers and cool flickering LEDs, which you can stick on your phone's back panel or the antenna. Watch them blink and jazz up your phone!

Carry It Safe

 Various types of carry pouches, belt clips and cases are available for different phones. Ranging from leather to cloth, you should be able to find one

memory format and the highest capacity supported by your phone.

Free Your Hands

 Handsfree adapters will free you from having to hold your phone all the while you speak. Depending on your budget and what your phone supports, you could go in for plain ones that start from Rs 100 for locally made ones and Rs 400 for the genuine thing.

If your phone has Bluetooth, go in for high-end Bluetooth wire-free headsets starting from Rs 2,800 (grey market). Original top-of-the-line handsfree sets from Nokia will set you back by Rs 6,000.

Looks apart, the reason you should look at Bluetooth handsfree is that it's wireless, and has a range of approximately 30 feet, so you can move around without being attached to your phone.

Another kind of handsfree that is gaining in popularity is radio handsfree. If your phone doesn't have a built in radio, then you can buy such a handsfree with integrated radio.

Phone Care Tips

 ☐ Never keep your phone near heat and magnetic sources (gas stoves, direct sunlight, audio speakers, etc).

☐ Switch off the device if it's not going to be used for some period of time. If you don't tend to use your phone for a long while, remove the battery and store it in a cool, dry place.

☐ Keep the device away from moisture and liquids. Avoid taking the phone into areas like kitchens or washrooms.

☐ Avoid storing or using it in dusty areas: the moving parts could get damaged.

☐ While charging the device, do not pull the adapter cord out of the device until the electricity supply is switched off.

☐ Switch off the phone before removing the battery or changing your SIM card.

☐ Use only approved accessories and batteries. Do not connect incompatible

products. Always use rated and factory-specified accessories for your phone. If, for example, you use a higher power rating charger, it will charge faster, but battery life could be lowered, and the phone could even get damaged.

☐ Never forget your cell phone in your vehicle—the heat could shorten the life of electronic devices, damage batteries and melt some plastic components.

Similarly, do not store your phone in cold areas because when the phone warms up to its normal temperature, moisture can form inside it, which could damage the electronic circuit boards.

☐ Never attempt to open the phone yourself, as non-expert handling of the device may damage it.

☐ If you wish to clean your phone, do not use harsh chemicals, cleaning solvents, or strong detergents. Use just a soft moist cloth.

☐ A new battery usually lasts for two years, provided you use it the right way. Never recharge a battery unnecessarily—this reduces the charge cycle. Always make sure you use the specified charger, else battery performance could be affected.

☐ Where temperature and humidity levels are high, your phone may stop functioning in extreme cases. If this happens, do not open the phone—take it to an authorised service centre.

Safety Tips

 ☐ Never use your phone while driving. It may not be a punishable offence in many places, but you could cause an accident. As an alternative, you could use one of the many handsfree accessories available today, but be warned that using these while driving could also be dangerous.

☐ Avoid taking a call while crossing the road, as your attention could be diverted—stand on the side if you must take a call.

☐ Always buy a cell phone that's SAR-approved. This ensures that the radiation emitted is minimal. ☒



Handsfree adapters make it safer to use your phone when you're driving

Look for zinc-air batteries, which can power your phone for really long

Support And Service

 What happens when your phone breaks down—does the warranty cover all the critical parts such as the circuit board, screen, software installation and firmware? Check before you buy.

that suits your requirements and style.

Memory

 If your phone supports memory expansion, you can go in for a compatible memory card to expand the available memory. This is useful for phones that do not have a lot of internal memory but offer features like an integrated camera, video recording, MP3 playback, etc. There are a variety of memory cards supported by different brands and product models.

Ranging from Memory Stick Duo to MultiMediaCard (MMC), and available in varying capacities, you need to check, before you buy, the

Mobile Accessories

Protect The Screen

 Even if you do not get a cover, you may be able to find a screen protector for your phone display. Since the display is one of the most expensive and fragile parts of your phone, it is important to protect it from scratches and other types of damage.